

Charles Stephen Thompson

DevOps & Automation Engineer · IAM/SSO · AI Workflow & MCP Integration

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Infrastructure and automation engineer with 14+ years building identity, CI/CD, and platform systems. I turn manual, multi-tool processes into resilient automation — increasingly with LLM agents in the loop: designing MCP (Model Context Protocol) servers, orchestrating n8n workflows, and wiring AI safely into real infrastructure and smart-building control. Deep specialization in identity & access management, infrastructure-as-code, and self-hosted platforms.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts, Modern American Legal History
The University of Chicago — Chicago, IL

2005 – 2010

BA Thesis on the misuse and abuse of copyright law as compared to that seen in the patent field.

SKILLS

AI & AUTOMATION

Claude / LLM APIs

MCP Servers

n8n

Ollama

RAG

Prompt Engineering

HOME & BUILDING AUTOMATION

Home Assistant

Homebridge / HomeKit

Matter

Zigbee

Z-Wave

IDENTITY & ACCESS

IAM

SAML / OIDC / OAuth2 (PKCE)

Okta

Active Directory

Kerberos/LDAP

ADFS

Pocket ID

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder, CEO & Principal Consultant
Brooklyn Helpdesk, Inc. — Brooklyn, NY

Jan 2018 – Present

- Architected a self-hosted AI automation platform: n8n workflows orchestrate LLM agents (Claude) to triage monitoring alerts, manage DNS, and drive CI/CD across a 40+ service private cloud
- Designed and deployed custom MCP (Model Context Protocol) servers exposing Forgejo git/CI, Grafana metrics, and a Wazuh SIEM so AI agents query and act on infrastructure under least-privilege scopes
- Built home & office automation with Home Assistant and Homebridge/HomeKit — presence-aware lighting, climate, window coverings, and A/V scene creation over Zigbee, Z-Wave, and Matter
- Modernized IAM with self-hosted OIDC SSO (Pocket ID, PKCE); run a rootless Podman container platform (systemd quadlets) with multi-arch CI via Forgejo Actions
- Operate a Technitium DNS cluster (DNSSEC-signed, split-horizon) and a full observability stack (Grafana, Prometheus, VictoriaLogs, InfluxDB)
- Consumer and SMB IT/DevOps across ~500 client devices (~\$7,500/month): IAM/SSO integration, CI/CD automation, and LAN/WiFi installation and maintenance

Director of IT & Infrastructure Engineer
Symbiont.io — New York, NY

Nov 2019 – Dec 2021

- Reduced onboarding time by 25% and costs by 12% via streamlined IAM/MDM integrations (Active Directory, GSuite, Okta, JAMF) to achieve SSO from hardware to cloud
- Designed and deployed automation software integrations for corporate IAM, user management, and hardware de/provisioning
- Deployed, monitored, and maintained Kubernetes and Docker stacks for a team of 36 engineers

GSuite

AUTOMATION & CONFIGURATION

Ansible

Chef

CloudFormation

Jenkins

MDM

Terraform

CircleCI

GitHub Actions

Forgejo Actions

Renovate

LANGUAGES & SCRIPTING

Bash

CoffeeScript

Go

Groovy

HTML

JavaScript

jQuery

Node.js

PHP

Python

Ruby

Shell Scripting

SQL

Swift

TeX

TypeScript

TOML / XML / YAML

Vue

PLATFORMS & MONITORING

Active Directory

AWS

Azure

Cloudflare

Docker

Elasticsearch

GCP

GitHub

Grafana

InfluxDB

JAMF

JumpCloud

Kibana

Kubernetes

Logstash

Nagios

Okta

Prometheus

Splunk

UniFi 802.1X

Zabbix

Podman

Technitium DNS / DNSSEC

Pocket ID

VictoriaLogs

Wazuh (SIEM)

TimescaleDB

TECH STANDARDS & CONCEPTS

Agile Workflow

CI/CD

Cloud Computing

Directory Services

Distributed Computing

DNS

IAM

LAMP Stack

Microservices

Monitoring

Remote Config & Management

SaaS

SAML / OIDC

Software Infrastructure Engineer & Interim Director of IT

Blink Health — New York, NY

Aug 2018 – Feb 2019

- Provisioned all Windows server instances with focus on Active Directory (fault tolerance, high availability) using Chef, Ansible, and Terraform
- Automated AD credential writing to GSuite, reducing onboarding steps from 40 to 4
- Leveraged Google SAML to reduce external attack surface and lower cost of SSO delivery
- Integrated Windows/Mac/Linux/GSuite auth via LDAP providing cross-platform SSO for VPNs, databases, and critical applications

Lead IT Infrastructure Engineer

Blink Health — New York, NY

Oct 2016 – Aug 2018

- Designed and managed UniFi 802.1X LAN/WiFi infrastructure at three sites with AWS connectivity via site-to-site VPN for 200+ staff
- Achieved infrastructure-as-code with GitHub PR support, CircleCI integration, and Terraform revision history across multiple AWS accounts
- Managed annual technology budget of \$5mm+ with inventory comprising hundreds of endpoints
- Grew IT team to 10 members across three geographic locations; oversaw opening of four offices in three states

AVP, Technology – Level III System & Network Engineer

Build America Mutual Assurance Company — New York, NY

Feb 2013 – May 2016

- Designed and implemented Active Directory backbone for SSO across Windows, Mac, and Linux using AD, Kerberos, LDAP, and MFA
- Implemented Jabber/XMPP with SSO and VOIP integration for the pre-existing phone system
- Migrated servers and applications to cloud providers, achieving \$250K+ in savings over five years
- Conducted Sarbanes-Oxley compliance reviews; supported nearly 100 users across three locations

Support Technician II

SecondMarket, Inc. — New York, NY

Jan 2012 – Jan 2013

- Configured SAML/ADFS SSO for Yammer, Salesforce, and Zendesk — saving the company \$36 per user per year
- Managed \$1.5M+ annual technology budget across three locations (New York, San Francisco, Hong Kong)

Version Control

MCP (Model Context Protocol)

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